

INTERNATIONAL news **Samsung nets \$6.4B for Texas chip plants**

Samsung has secured \$6.4 billion from the US Commerce Department to expand semiconductor manufacturing in Taylor and Austin, Texas, aiming to boost US chip production and enhance AI and national security technology. The funding has been provided to construct two new logic fabrication plants and expand an existing facility, generating over 21,500 jobs. The investment totals over \$40 billion regionally with a focus on 4nm and 2nm process technologies for logic foundry fabs and advanced 3D high bandwidth memory and 2.5D packaging in the R&D facility.

Microsoft invests \$1.5B in Emirati AI firm G42

Microsoft is investing \$1.5 billion in the Emirati AI firm G42, acquiring a minority stake and a seat on the board. G42 will utilise Microsoft's Azure cloud platform to deploy its AI applications for global public sector clients and large enterprises. Microsoft and G42 plan to establish a \$1 billion fund to enhance AI skills in the UAE and the broader region. The deal includes safeguards to protect AI products, such as the removal of Huawei telecom equipment from G42's operations. G42 will leverage Microsoft's Azure data centres to enhance regional adoption of AI infrastructure.

Microchip acquires Neuronix AI Labs to strengthen AI FPGA development

Microchip Technology is acquiring Neuronix AI Labs to strengthen the development of its AI-enabled edge solutions utilising field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs). Microchip's PolarFire FPGAs and SoCs are recognised for low power consumption, reliability, and security, and integrating Neuronix's technology aims to provide more cost-effective and scalable solutions for computer vision applications. Integration of Neuronix AI intellectual property with Microchip's existing compilers and software design kits enables implementation of AI/ML algorithms directly onto customisable FPGA logic without deep familiarity with FPGA architecture.

Valero opens new plant in Korea for production of ADAS components

Valero has inaugurated a new production facility in Daegu, South Korea, which is focused on manufacturing sensors for vehicle automation, following a \$56 million investment agreement with the Daegu Metropolitan Government. The plant, currently producing parking assistant sensors, aims to become a major Asian hub for autonomous driving sensors, including ultrasound sensors, radars, cameras, and lidars, catering to local and export demands for advanced driver assistance systems (ADAS) and autonomous vehicles.

Veira Group to invest ₹4.5B in their third manufacturing unit

Contract manufacturer Veira will be investing 4.5 billion rupees in setting up a new manufacturing unit at Greater Noida, to increase production capacity for air coolers and washing machines from the existing 100,000 to 500,000 units annually, for both domestic and international

markets. Additionally, the company anticipates these product segments to contribute 15% to their revenue by the end of FY25. The company already has two facilities in Noida.

Apple India sales grow amid overall decline in sales in Q1

Apple reported a 4% decline in overall sales for the first quarter, primarily led by a slump in China. However,

Tesla initiates production of right-hand drive cars in Germany for India

Tesla has initiated the production of right-hand drive cars at its plant in Germany for export to India. The specific model for India remains undisclosed, with the Berlin factory currently manufacturing the



Representational image

Model Y. This marks the first indication of right-hand drive cars produced in Berlin for Tesla, which have earlier been manufactured at its Shanghai plant located nearer to right-hand-drive markets, such as Australia and Japan.

Vulcan Energy starts its first lithium chloride production in Germany

Vulcan Energy has initiated production of lithium chloride in Germany using geothermal energy, to produce battery-grade lithium hydroxide, marking the first locally sourced lithium in Germany, extracted from underground reservoirs in the Upper Rhine Valley region. Vulcan Energy, with offtake agreements with automakers like Volkswagen and Renault, is progressing towards its goal of building a large-scale industrial plant with an annual output of 24,000 tonnes of lithium hydroxide by 2026. Financing for the project, including a potential 500 million euro loan from the European Investment Bank, is underway.

Power Integrations acquiring Odyssey Semiconductor to accelerate GaN tech development

Power Integrations is acquiring the assets of Odyssey Semiconductor Technologies, a developer of vertical gallium-nitride (GaN) transistor technology. Power integration aims to expand the voltage and power capabilities of its proprietary PowiGaN technology, targeting cost parity with silicon MOSFETs. Key Odyssey employees are expected to join Power Integrations' technology organisation.